

VISUAL CONCEPT ATLAS

Feel the Fear and Do It Anyway

Dr. Susan Jeffers

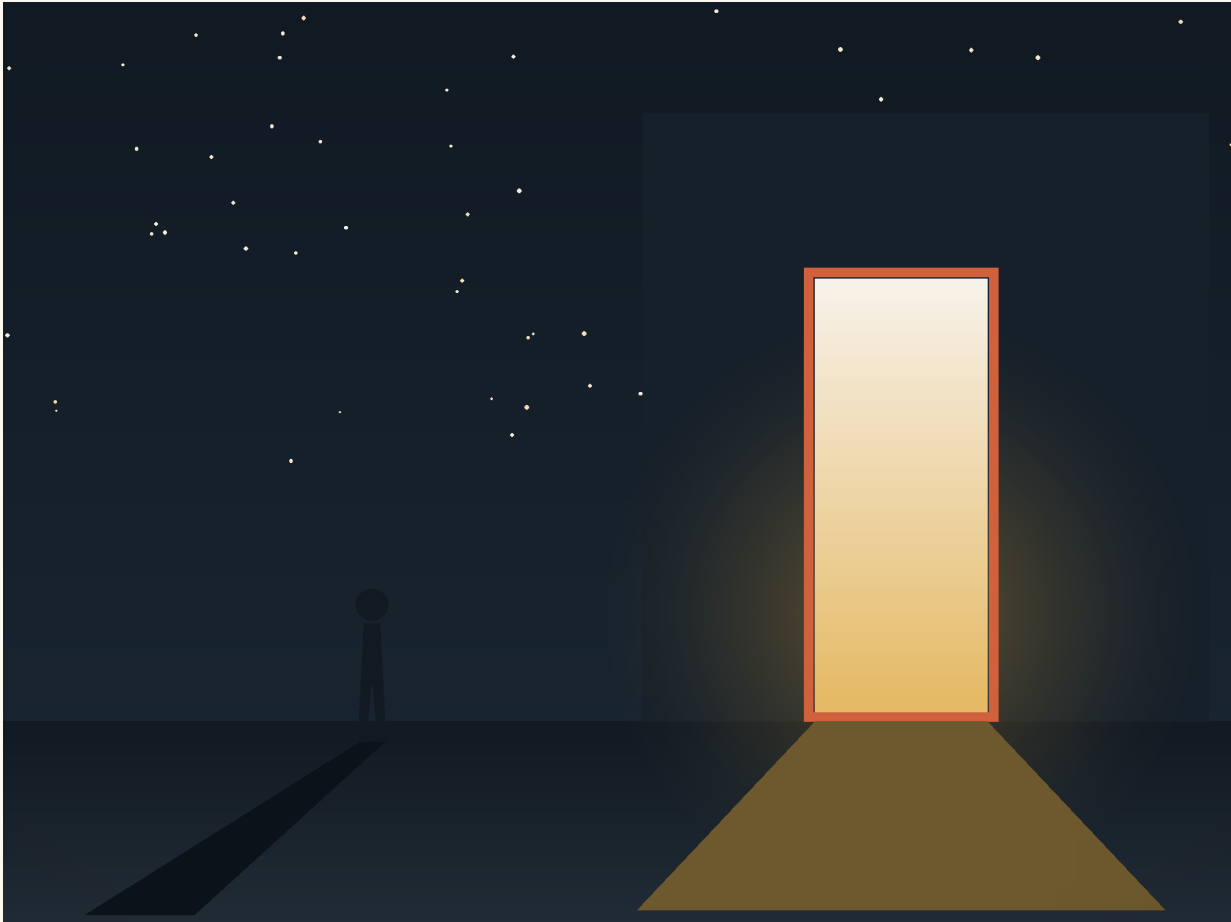
Audio Companion — the images, explained



WELCOME

This companion walks you through the sixteen images of the Feel the Fear Visual Concept Atlas, the way a guide walks you through a gallery. The images follow the book's arc from dusk to dawn — from the anatomy of fear, through taking back the controls of your own mind, into action, and finally out into the larger life of yes, giving, and the Higher Self. Each section shows you one image, then explains what you are seeing, which idea from Susan Jeffers's book it captures, why it matters, and how to use it. The images are designed to work as memory triggers: after this walk-through, a single glance at any one of them should bring the whole teaching back. Take them slowly. There is plenty of time.

The Doorway of Fear



You are looking at a small figure standing in darkness before a tall doorway filled with warm light. Notice two details. The figure's shadow stretches long behind it, back into the dark — that is the past, the familiar, the life that isn't working but is known. And the light doesn't reach the figure yet; it only spills onto the floor between them. This is the geometry of every fear in the book: the good thing is visible, the distance is short, and nothing physical blocks the way. What blocks the way is the doorway itself — the threshold, the moment of stepping into unfamiliar territory.

This is Susan Jeffers's own mirror moment — the morning she shouted enough at her reflection and chose to walk through. In real life, notice whenever you can see exactly what you want and find yourself explaining why you're still standing in the dark. The application is the book's title: the fear doesn't have to leave before you move. You move, and the light meets you.

The principle to remember: The trick is to feel the fear — and walk through anyway.

Three Levels, One Root

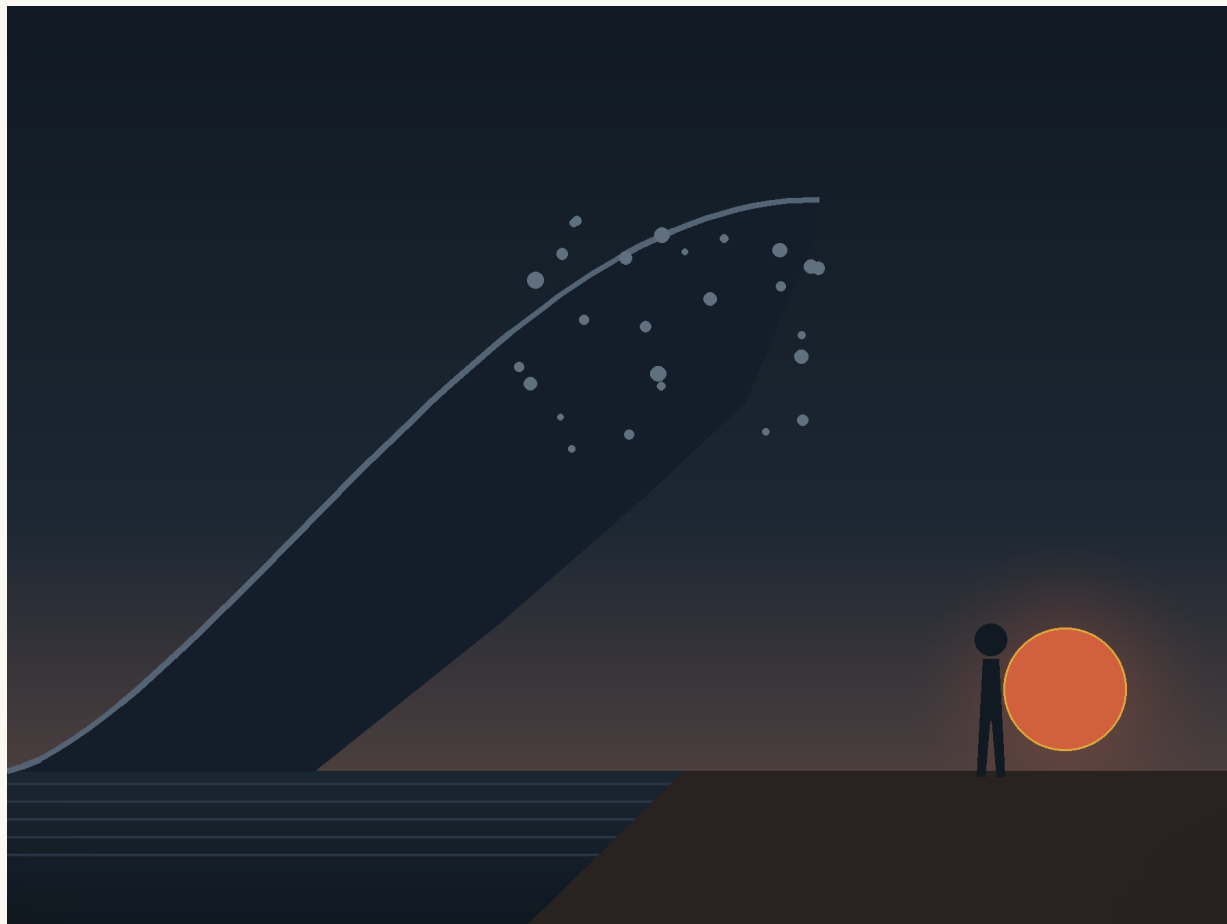


This is fear seen in cross-section. A figure stands on the surface, and beneath its feet the ground descends in three layers. The top layer is scattered with many small shards — the level-one fears, the surface stories: illness, public speaking, changing jobs, being alone. The middle layer holds fewer, larger shards tinged with ember — the level-two ego fears: rejection, failure, success, vulnerability. And at the bottom, every root line converges on a single glowing core. That core is the level-three fear, the only fear there really is: I can't handle it.

Notice that the surface shards are many and the core is one — that is why fighting fears one at a time never ends, and why building self-trust ends all of them at once. In real life, whenever a new surface fear appears, trace it down: what am I really saying I couldn't handle? Then work at the core, not the surface. You never have to control the outside world — only to strengthen the ground you stand on.

The principle to remember: Every fear is the same fear. Handle the root and the surface goes quiet.

I'll Handle It



An enormous dark wave rises on the left — and on the right, a small figure stands on the shore, upright and still, with a low warm sun at its back. The wave is everything you cannot control: the diagnosis, the layoff, the loss, the change that arrives without permission. Notice what the figure is not doing. It is not running, not crouching, not commanding the wave to stop. Its whole power is in its posture.

This is Janice's story — the woman whose safe, husband-managed life was saturated with silent dread until his stroke forced her to discover she could handle everything she had feared. The wave came, and she stood. In real life, notice the difference between the fear of events and the fear of your own collapse; only the second one keeps you up at night, and only the second one is yours to fix. Apply the three most important words in the book to every what-if your mind produces.

The principle to remember: Whatever happens: I'll handle it.

Fear at Every New Threshold

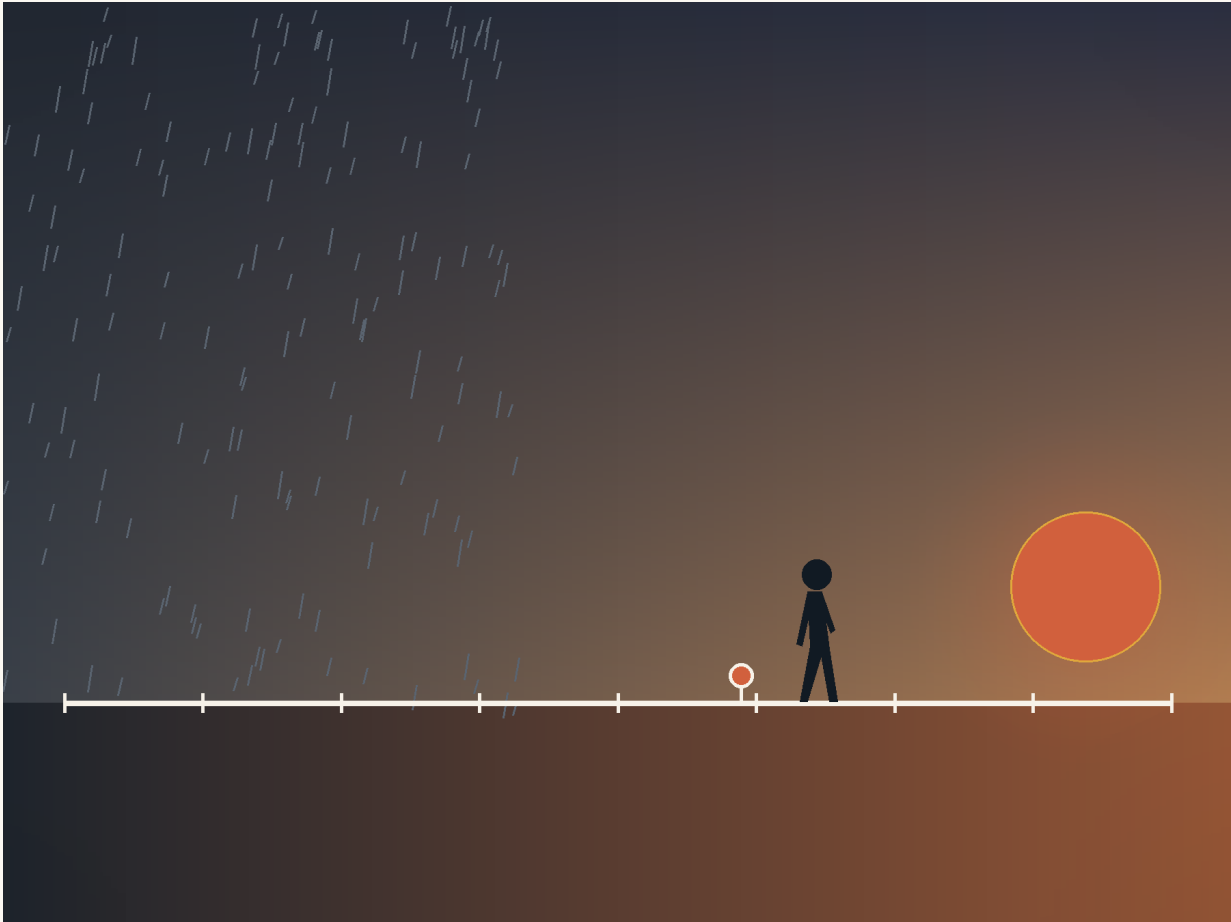


A staircase climbs from the lower left toward light, and on every single landing stands a door — with a small coil of grey wisp curling above each one. A figure is climbing between landings. The wisps are the point: there is one at every door, including the highest. Fear does not live at the bottom of the staircase where beginners are; it lives at every threshold, forever, because each new level is unfamiliar territory.

This is the picture of the five truths about fear — especially the first and fourth: the fear never goes away as long as you keep growing, and everyone on the staircase feels it, including the people at the top you've been envying. Remember the mayor of New York, terrified of learning a simple tap dance. In real life, notice when you interpret fear as evidence something is wrong. Reread it as evidence you are at a door. Doors are what growth looks like from up close.

The principle to remember: Fear at the threshold means you're growing — it's a green light, not a stop sign.

The Pain-to-Power Line

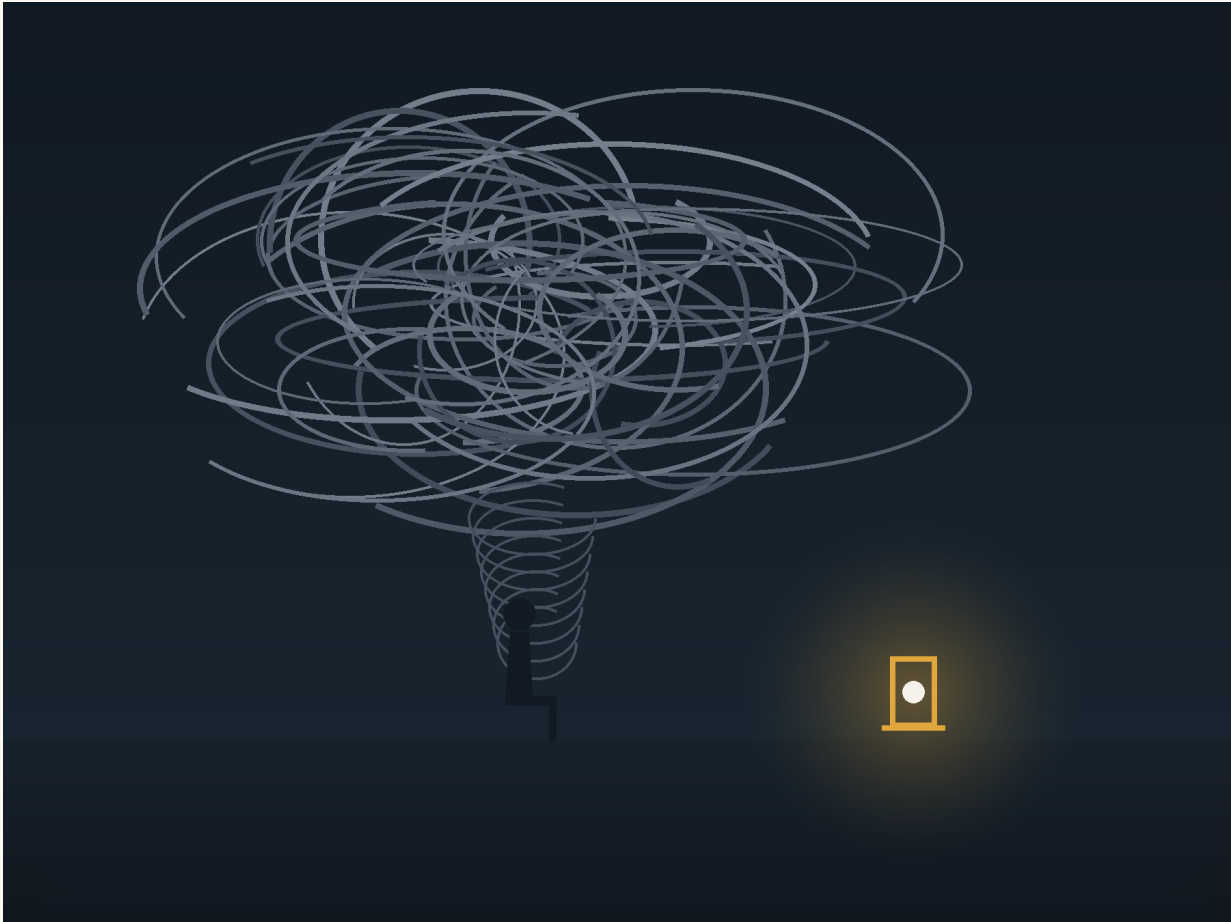


A single measured line runs across the scene like a fence rail. On the left, the world is grey and raining; on the right, an ember sun is up and the ground is warm. A marker pin sits past the midpoint, and the figure is walking — not standing — toward the light. The line is Jeffers's pain-to-power chart: pain on the left with its helplessness, depression, and paralysis; power on the right with its choice, energy, and action.

Notice that the weather changes along the line but the line itself is level — the journey is not a climb, just a direction, walked in small daily steps: a risk a day, a stronger sentence, a pin moved. In real life, before any decision, ask the chart's one question: does this move me toward power or toward pain? And notice the pin is yours alone to place — no one else can judge your position, because it is measured entirely by your inner sense of peace and growth.

The principle to remember: Move the pin. Every risk, every word, every choice shifts you left or right.

The Chatterbox



A figure sits under an enormous tangled scribble — a cloud made of loops and knots with a thread descending straight toward its head. To the right, small and easy to miss, a lantern glows steadily on the ground. The scribble is the chatterbox: the nonstop inner voice of doom, lack, and losing that most of us don't even notice is talking — the if-I-call-him spiral, the they-left-me-out-of-the-meeting spiral. Notice its size compared to the figure. That is honest: unchallenged, it fills the whole sky.

But notice also that the lantern is lit. The loving inner voice already exists — it is simply quieter, and it must be chosen, sentence by sentence. In real life, catch the scribble in the act: the moment you can't sit in a silent room, it's because the room isn't silent. The application is Jeffers's beginner's intensive — affirmations at the mirror, inspiration in the car, kindness at bedtime — not to silence the cloud but to outtalk it until the lantern becomes the louder light.

The principle to remember: You don't silence the chatterbox. You outtalk it.

Handing Away Your Power

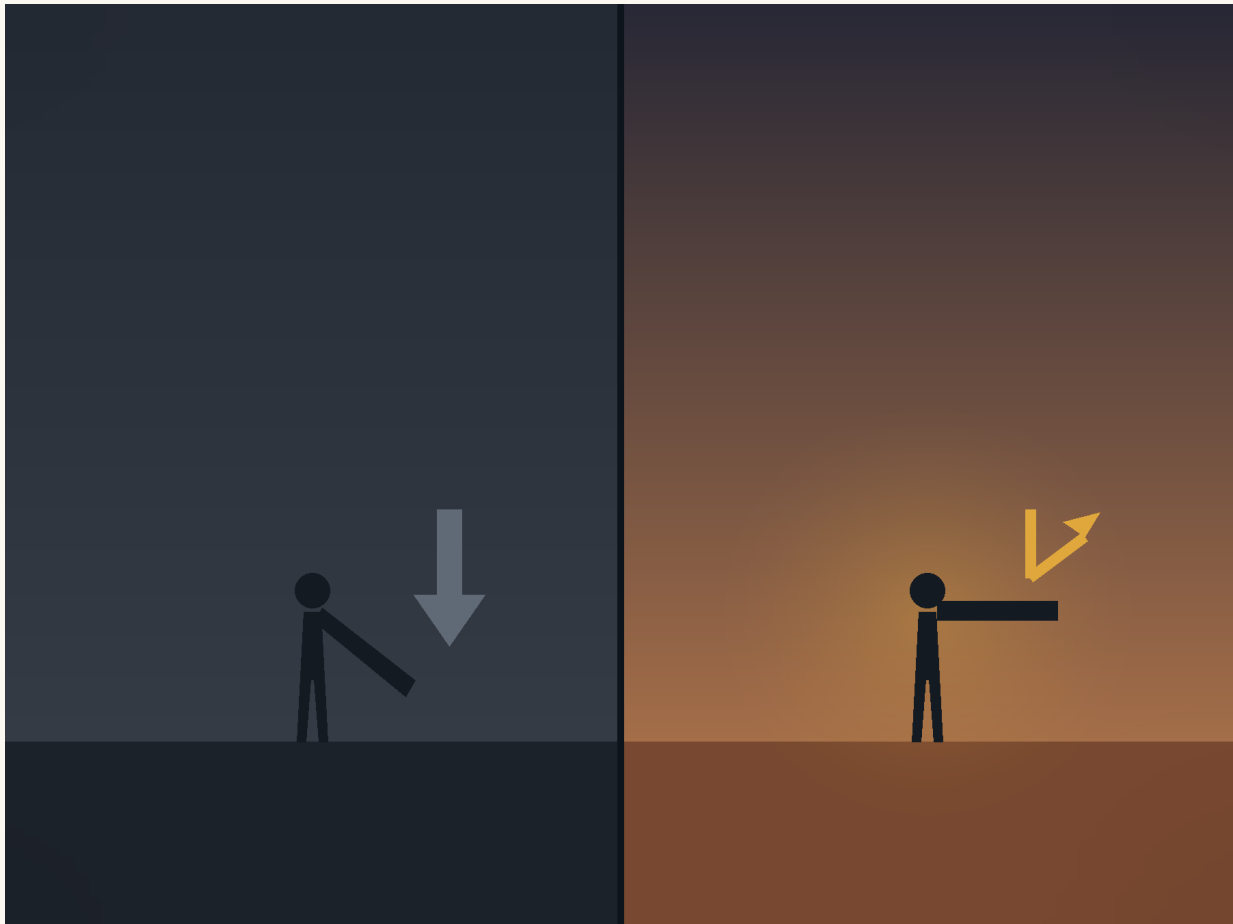


A small figure reaches out, releasing a glowing ember orb — and across from it, a crowd of much larger, darker figures reaches to receive it. The orb is the figure's power: its energy, its mood, its verdict on its own life. Notice who is large and who is small in this picture, and notice the direction of the handoff. The big figures did not take the orb. It is being given.

This is the victim mentality drawn as a transaction — Edward blaming his wife, boss, and son for his anxiety; Mara narrating her ex-husband's crimes; Jeffers's own moan-and-groan phone calls about the men in her life. Every blame is a delivery of the orb. In real life, use the telltale signs as tracking marks — anger, envy, self-pity, helplessness, the urge to control — and when you find one, ask her question: what am I not doing in my life that I'm blaming them for not doing for me? Then take the orb back. It was always yours; that's why the crowd could only receive it.

The principle to remember: Anger is the clue. Take the orb back.

The Arm Experiment

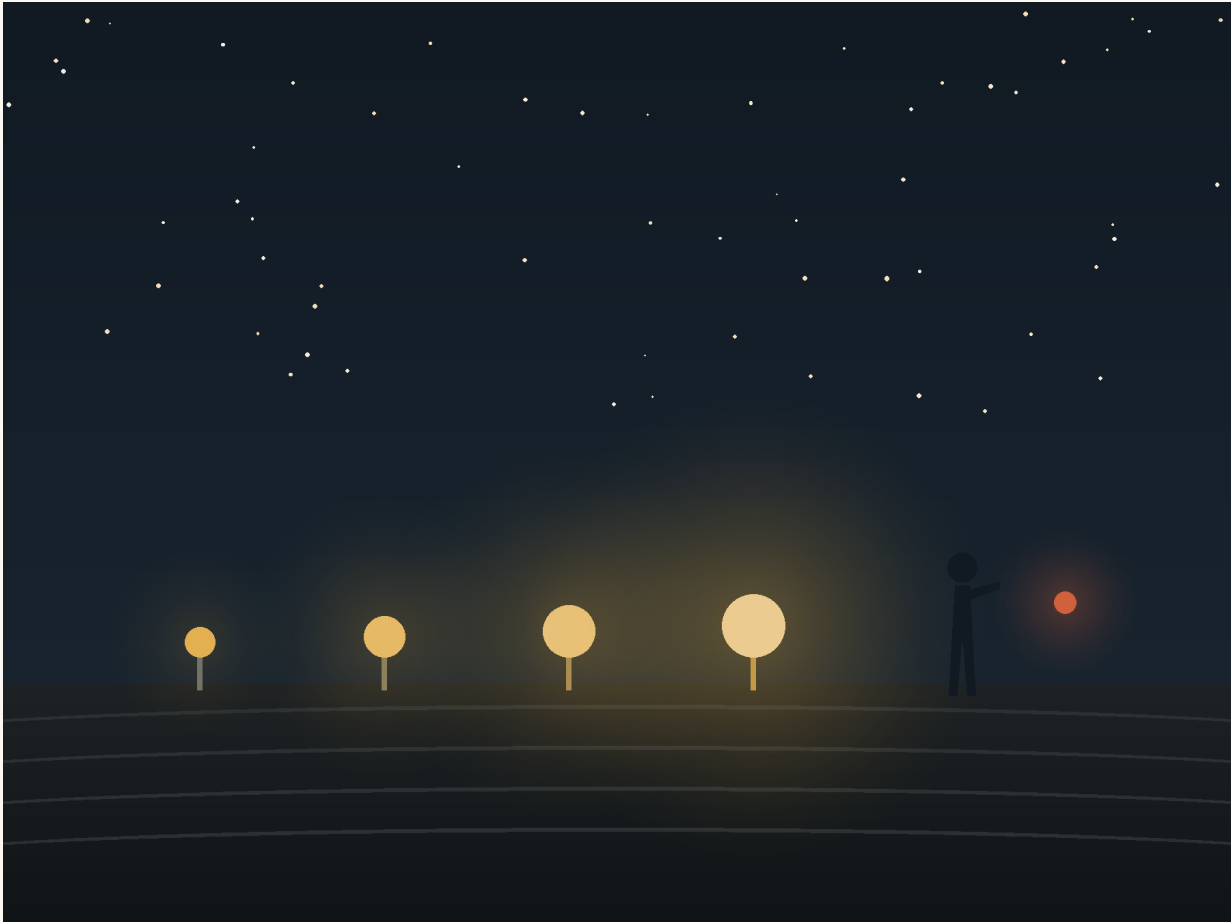


One scene, split down the middle — the same figure twice. On the grey left, the figure's extended arm droops as a heavy arrow presses down: it has just repeated, ten times, I am a weak and unworthy person. On the warm right, the same figure stands inside a gold aura, arm level and immovable — the pressure arrow bends away, deflected: I am a strong and worthy person. Nothing else differs. Not the body, not the push. Only the words.

This is the demonstration Jeffers performs in every workshop, learned from Jack Canfield — and she ran it blind, leaving the room while the class chose the sentence, and the arm still knew. The point the picture insists on: the inner self does not check whether the words are true, and it does not wait for belief. It simply executes what it is fed. In real life, listen to your own casual sentences — I can't, I'm terrible with, isn't that awful — as physical instructions. Then feed the arm what you want it to do.

The principle to remember: Your words are orders. Speak strength, whether you believe it yet or not.

Planting Affirmations

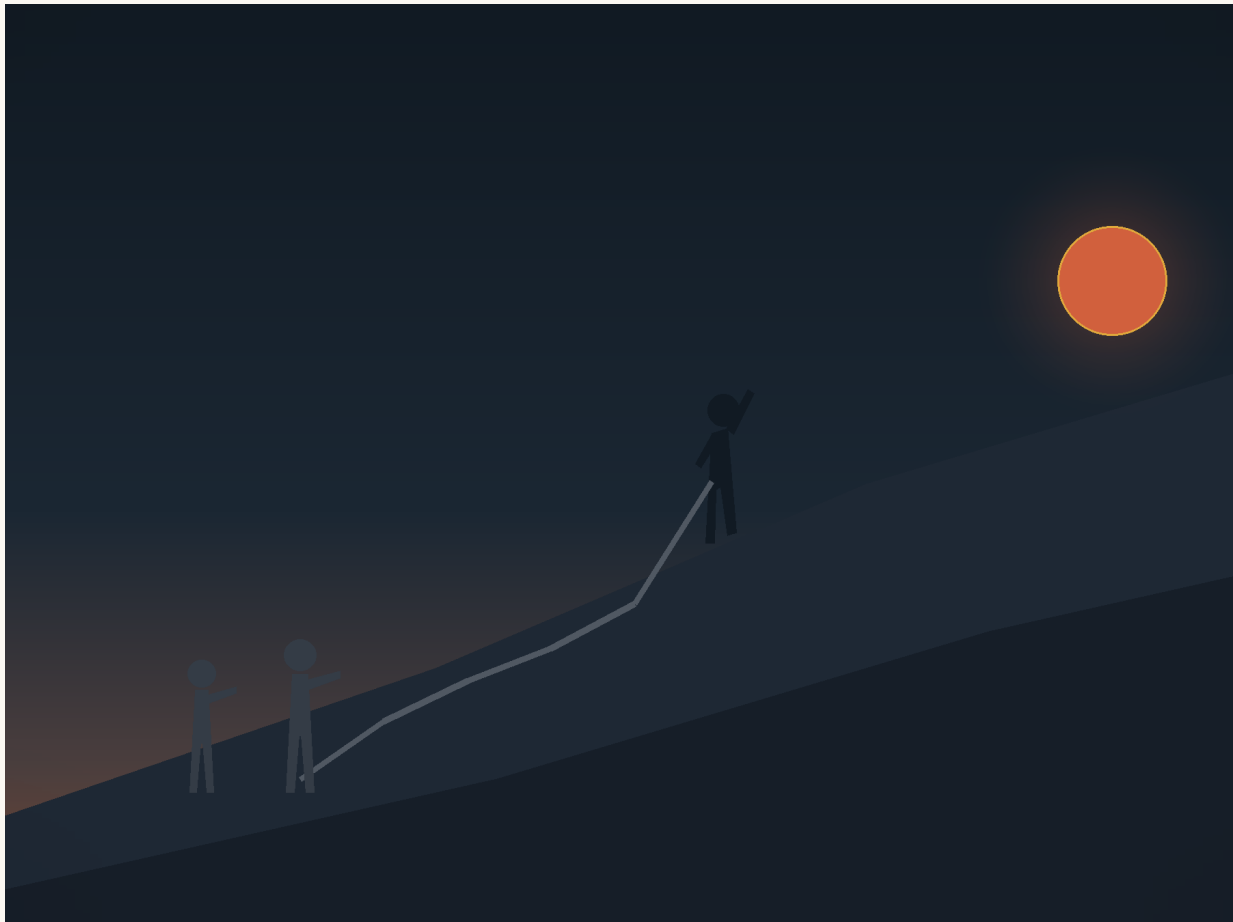


A figure kneels in dark furrowed soil at night, setting a small ember seed of light into the ground — and behind it, a row of already-planted lanterns grows taller and brighter down the line. The seed is an affirmation: one present-tense sentence — I am now handling all my fears — spoken today, in the dark, before there is any evidence. The row shows what repetition does: each earlier planting has grown, and the light compounds.

Notice that the newest seed is the dimmest and the work still looks like night. That is what the practice feels like from inside — which is why most people quit. In real life, treat affirmations as agriculture, not magic: present tense, positively phrased, repeated daily at the mirror and in the car, for a month before you judge the harvest. The chatterbox will call it silly. That's fine. The arm experiment already proved the soil doesn't care what the chatterbox thinks.

The principle to remember: Plant the sentence daily. Repetition is what makes it grow.

When They Don't Want You to Grow

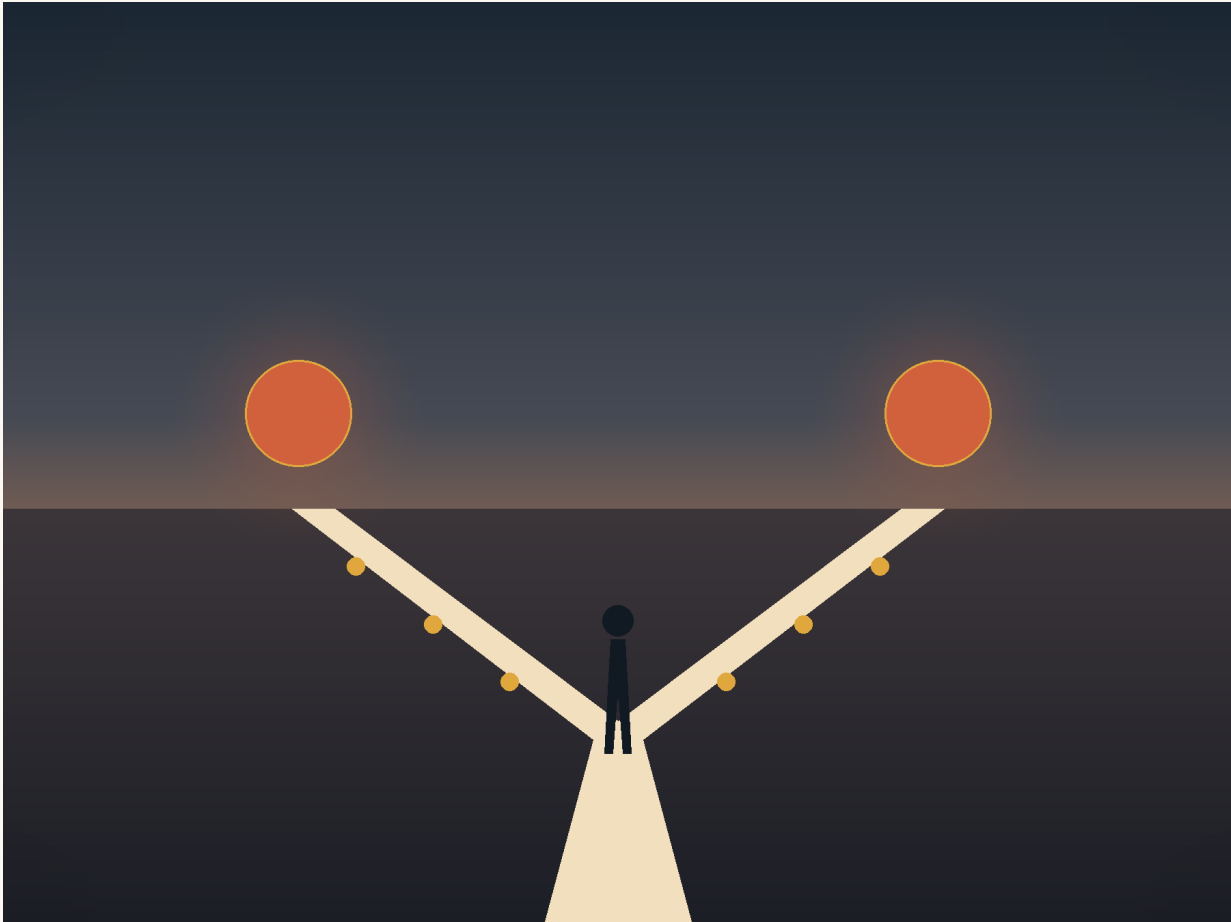


A figure is climbing a long slope toward a summit lit by a warm sun — and a rope runs from its waist back down the hill, held by grey figures below. Notice that the grey figures are not villains in this picture; they are simply standing where the climber used to stand, holding on. That is what resistance from loved ones usually is: not malice but security — the fear of losing the person they knew, and of what your growth says about their standing still.

This is Ted planting fear-thoughts every time the recovering Doris left the house, threatened by a wife who suddenly didn't need him — until her calm certainty gave him the safety to let go and become her biggest supporter. In real life, expect the rope; being surprised by it is what yanks people back into old patterns. Apply the win-win response — thank you for your concern, and I know I'll handle it — keep climbing at your own pace, and remember: usually, inner strength is respected. Many rope-holders eventually start to climb.

The principle to remember: When you rock the boat, someone will say sit down. Keep climbing — kindly.

The No-Lose Fork

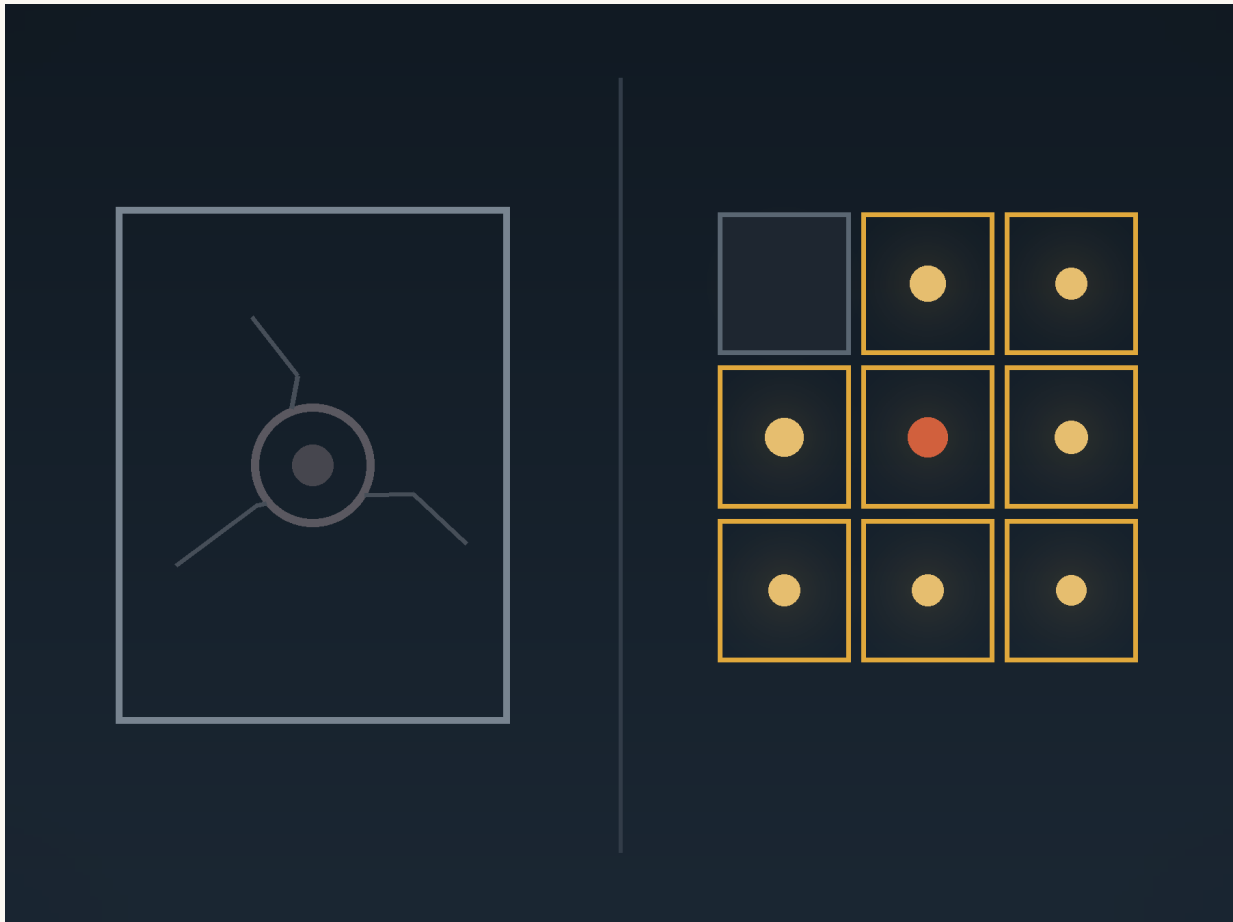


A road arrives at a fork, and a figure stands at the split. Look at the two branches: both are paved in the same pale gold, both are dotted with the same small bright markers, and — the detail that matters most — there is a sun over each horizon. Neither path is the dark one. That is the entire no-lose model in a single image: at every genuine choice point, both paths are right, because both are strewn with what Jeffers calls goodies — chances to learn, grow, and find out who you are.

This is Alex leaving law school for psychology: the years his father called wasted produced self-reliance, lifelong friends, and the wife he met working construction. In real life, notice the moment your mind starts trying to predict which path is the right one — that is the no-win model starting its engine. Replace the question. Not which is right, but which lessons do I choose — strawberries or blueberries. Then walk, and if the path stops fitting: don't protect, correct.

The principle to remember: There are no wrong decisions — only different classrooms.

One Big Letter vs. Nine Boxes



Two lives, side by side. On the left, one large frame holds a single dim circle — and cracks are spreading from it. This is Louise's square: Jim was my whole life, so when Jim left, the whole structure failed. On the right, the same space is divided into nine glowing boxes — relationship, work, family, friends, hobby, leisure, alone time, growth, contribution. Notice that one of the nine has gone dark. That is the honest part of the picture: loss still happens to whole people. But look at what surrounds the dark box — eight rooms still lit.

In real life, notice which single box gets all your daily goals; for most people it's work, for some a person. The application is structural, not emotional: build the grid, then bring the magic duo to every box — one hundred percent commitment, plus acting as if you count — the way Sandy turned a boring temporary job into a place she thrived by bringing in a plant and a goal list. Neediness is not cured by getting more from the one box. It is cured by lighting the other eight.

The principle to remember: You can't be devastated by one loss when no one thing is everything.

Nodding Yes as the Storm Passes



Half this sky is storm — heavy cloud and slanting rain on the left — and half is breaking open, a sun with visible rays on the right. In the middle stands a figure with its face lifted and one arm raised, standing in the weather rather than fleeing it. The gesture is the practice: whatever happens, nod your head up and down instead of shaking it side to side. Say yes to your universe — to the flow of events you never got to vote on.

The raised face matters: yes is not resignation, and it does not skip the rain. It is Nadine crying sweetly over her mother and saying thanks; it is Charles, paralyzed in a street fight, wheeling into the middle of a frozen party and starting the dancing; it is Frankl's last human freedom — choosing one's attitude in any circumstance. In real life, train the nod on trivia — the traffic jam, the spilled milk — so the reflex exists on the day the storm is real. Feel the pain fully; then find what can be made from what happened.

The principle to remember: There is the pain of yes and the pain of no. Nod your head.

Light That Doesn't Diminish



Two figures face each other in the dark, each holding a lantern — and the flames are exactly equal. One has just lit the other. That is the detail to sit with: giving light away cost the giver nothing. The scene is Jeffers's answer to the scarcity crouch — the childlike certainty that there is not enough love, credit, praise, or money to go around, which is why most of what we call giving is secretly a barter system.

This is the class that could barely say thank you to their own spouses; it is Jeffers sharing her hard-won professional knowledge with competitors who became her closest allies. In real life, notice the flinch before you give — the fear that praise spent on someone else is subtracted from you. Then run the experiment: give away thanks, information, praise, time, and watch your own flame. The paradox is the whole teaching: you only feel abundant after you give, never before. And if your purpose is giving, you cannot even be conned — whoever takes is fulfilling your purpose.

The principle to remember: The trick in life is not what you can get, but what you can give.

The Higher Self Above the Fog

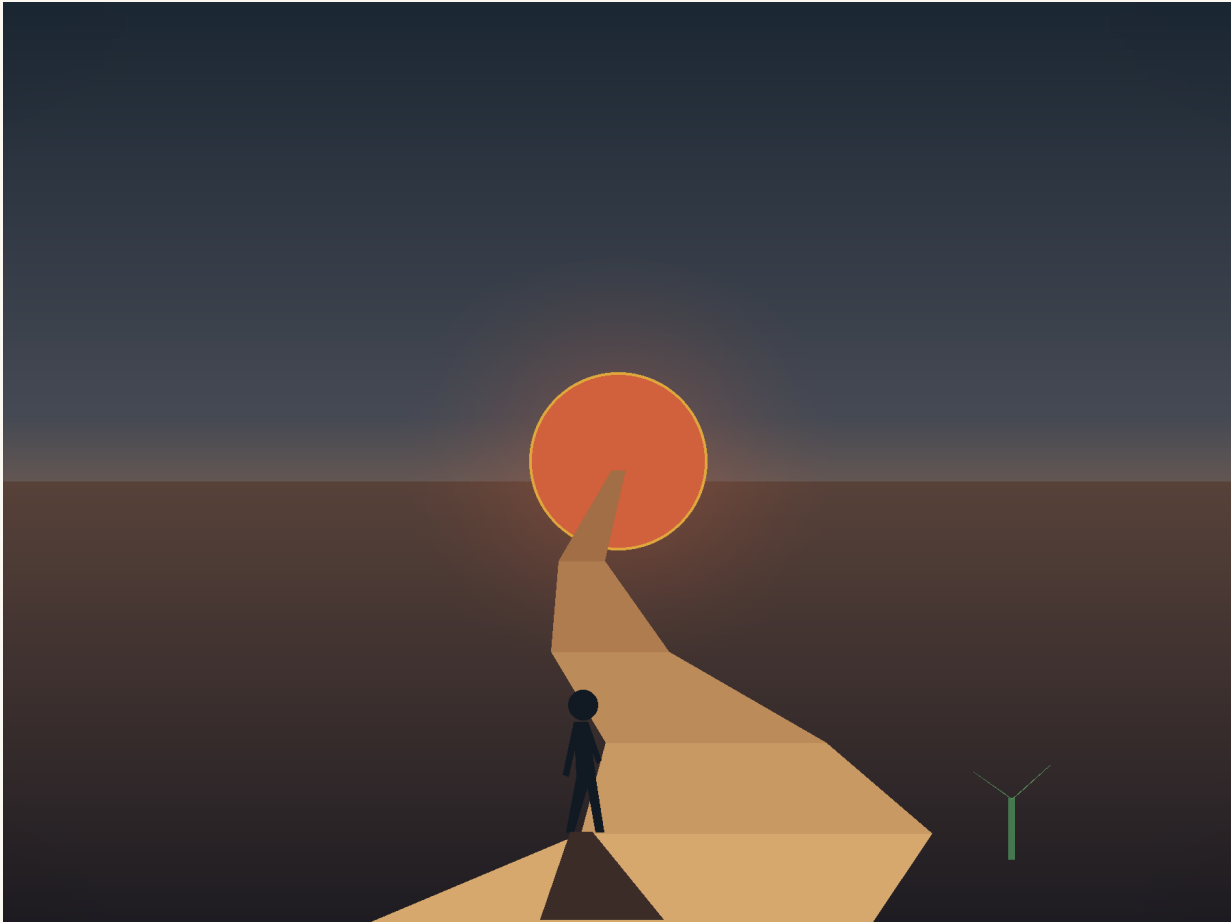


A sea of fog fills the valley, and a single peak rises through it. At the summit, a figure holds a flame overhead — small against the night, but the only light in the scene, burning above the cloud layer. The fog is the chatterbox's altitude: the petty, the anxious, the not-enough — he never called, she didn't say thank you, what if the money runs out. The flame is what Jeffers calls the Higher Self: the place within that is creative, intuitive, trusting, loving, and abundant — the place all the book's tools are secretly designed to reach.

Notice that the fog is not gone; the figure has simply climbed above it. That is what centering does. In real life, the homesick, empty feeling you medicate with new jobs and new purchases is the signal that you're below your own cloud line. The application is a standing appointment: make the Higher Self the first box of every morning — quiet, affirmation, visualization — because it is the one box that feeds all the others. From up there, the protocol writes itself: this is not my life; I let go; it's all happening perfectly.

The principle to remember: Climb above the fog daily. The flame is already yours.

There Is Plenty of Time



A road winds toward a rising sun, and a figure walks it — early on the road, nowhere near the horizon. In the near foreground, a seedling stands in dark soil. Those are the two clocks in the picture. The road says the journey is long by design: there are quick and wonderful books, but no quick tools — these are practiced for a lifetime. The seedling is the boy who pulled a chair up to his flower pot and sat watching, waiting for the flower — not knowing that under the soil, everything was already happening.

Notice the light: it is dawn, not noon. Early is the permanent condition of a growing person, and Jeffers keeps her own perspective with Lena Horne's line — I've come a long way, maybe. In real life, catch impatience in the act and name it for what it is: self-punishment that manufactures stress and fear. Answer the rushing chatterbox out loud: what's the rush? It's all happening perfectly. Then take the next step on the road — because nothing takes unless you take it.

The principle to remember: It's all happening perfectly — and there is plenty of time.

CLOSING

Seen in sequence, the sixteen images tell one story. A figure stands in the dark before a lit doorway, discovers that all its many fears share a single root, and learns the three words that dissolve them. It finds the staircase where fear waits at every landing and starts walking the long level line from pain to power. It sits under the scribble of its own chatterbox and lights a lantern instead; it takes back the orb it had been handing to others; it learns from its own arm that words are orders, and starts planting them like seeds. Rope-holders tug from below and it climbs anyway. It reaches the fork and finds both roads lit, builds nine rooms so no single loss can empty the house, and lifts its face to nod yes at the weather. Then it discovers the light that doesn't diminish when shared, carries its flame above the fog, and walks the dawn road at its own pace — because it is all happening perfectly, and there is plenty of time. Whenever fear returns, find yourself in this sequence: whichever image you are living in today, the next one shows the way forward. Feel the fear — and do it anyway.